Week 3: Boiling point and pressure

A liquid boils when its vapour pressure equals the pressure of the gas above it.

At sea level, atmospheric pressure is 101.3 kPa and pure water boils at 100 °C.

Air pressure falls with altitude, so at 3,000 m water boils at about 90 °C.

A pressure cooker raises the pressure above the water, which raises its boiling point to about 120 °C.